



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN  
SESSION 2025-26  
PRE BOARD EXAMINATION

CLASS: X  
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER II (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 80  
TIME: 2 HOURS

*Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.  
You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.  
This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.  
The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.*

*The paper has four sections.  
Section A is compulsory- All questions in Section A must be answered.  
You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C and D and one other question from  
any section of your choice.  
The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [ ].  
This paper consists of six printed pages.*

**SECTION A**

(Attempt all questions from this Section)

**Question 1**

Choose the correct answers to the questions from the given options.

[16]

(Do not copy the questions, write *ONLY* the correct answers.)

- (i) Which line from Antony's speech best shows his effective use of irony?
- (a) "You all did love him once, not without cause."
  - (b) "Here, under leave of Brutus and the rest- for Brutus is an honourable man."
  - (c) "O, pardon me, thou bleeding piece of earth."
  - (d) "This was the most unkindest cut of all."
- (ii) Select the option that shows the correct relationship between Statements (1) and (2) from *Julius Caesar*:
- Statement 1: Antony calls Brutus "the noblest Roman of them all."  
Statement 2: He believes Brutus acted from genuine patriotism, not envy.
- (a) Statement 2 is the reason for Statement 1.
  - (b) Statement 1 is true, Statement 2 is false.
  - (c) Both the Statements are true but Statement 2 is not the reason for Statement 1.
  - (d) Both the Statements are unrelated and independent of each other.
- (iii) "This is a slight unmeritable man, meet to be sent on errands." Who is being spoken about and by whom?
- (a) Pindarus by Brutus
  - (b) Lucius Pella by Brutus
  - (c) Lepidus by Antony
  - (d) Messala by Cassius

- (iv) Choose the option that lists the sequence of events from William Shakespeare's play 'Julius Caesar' in the correct order:
1. Brutus accuses Cassius of having an "itching palm".
  2. Cassius protests and says that he did not deny to send money to Brutus and the messenger who brought the news was a fool.
  3. Brutus reveals the news of Portia's death.
  4. Caesar's ghost appears before Brutus.
- (a) 3, 2, 4, 1
  - (b) 4, 1, 2, 3
  - (c) 1, 2, 3, 4
  - (d) 2, 3, 4, 1
- (v) How does Cassius feel when he says, "*Caesar, thou art reveng'd, even with the sword that kill'd thee.*"?
- (a) cheerful at being able to escape Rome
  - (b) confused about what was happening at the battlefield
  - (c) betrayed by Brutus in the same way he had betrayed Caesar
  - (d) disheartened that his downfall is a consequence of his betrayal against Caesar
- (vi) Choose the option that has a similar figure of speech as in the line quoted below:  
*"Is thronged with quiet, inoffensive ghosts,  
 As silent as the pictures on the wall."* (Haunted Houses)
- (a) *Or does it dry up  
 Like a raisin in the sun?*
  - (b) *Ten thousand I saw at a glance  
 Tossing their heads in sprightly dance.*
  - (c) *Because I could not stop for Death,  
 He kindly stopped for me.*
  - (d) *The fair breeze blow, the white foam flew  
 The furrow followed free.*
- (vii) "*When something strange about it made me think*" suggests that the poet \_\_\_\_\_.  
 (A Considerable Speck)
- (a) was distracted
  - (b) noticed intelligent movement in the speck
  - (c) saw that the speck was vanishing
  - (d) enjoyed the sadistic pleasure of killing it
- (viii) Which of the following options best describes the bridge of light that descends from the world of spirits? (Haunted Houses)
- (a) trembling and unsteady
  - (b) concrete and firm
  - (c) made of steel
  - (d) narrow and dark
- (ix) What happens to the bullock-carts when Bhisma Lochan Sharma sings?  
 (The Power of Music)
- (a) break
  - (b) overturn
  - (c) collapse
  - (d) disappear

- (x) Which of the following is NOT true regarding Maya Angelou's poem, *When Great Trees fall*?
- (a) The poem describes the grief felt when a great person dies.
  - (b) The poem suggests that great people leave no lasting impact.
  - (c) The poet compares the death of great people to falling trees.
  - (d) The poem suggests that the memories of our loved one are precious.
- (xi) What does the poet mean by the line:  
*"All houses wherein men have lived and died/ Are haunted houses."*? (Haunted Houses)
- (a) The poet believes that harmful ghosts live in every house.
  - (b) The poet warns people not to enter old buildings.
  - (c) The poet feels that the memories and spirits of the dead linger in every house.
  - (d) All old houses have guests living in them.
- (xii) If language is the key to freedom, what does losing the right to learn French represent in the story? (The Last Lesson)
- (a) losing cultural identity and self-respect
  - (b) losing a subject at school due to less marks
  - (c) developing a one language philosophy as a part of globalization
  - (d) access to better educational opportunities
- (xiii) The author's perspective on traditional gender roles is reflected in which of the given statements? (The Girl Who Can)
- (a) Girls should confine themselves to domestic chores.
  - (b) Girls should challenge stereotypes and break boundaries.
  - (c) Girls cannot participate in sports.
  - (d) Men are superior to women.
- (xiv) How does Martin's father react to his fear of the elevator? (The Elevator)
- (a) He is sympathetic and understanding.
  - (b) He tells Martin to avoid the elevator.
  - (c) He also becomes afraid like his son.
  - (d) He gets angry and tells Martin to grow up.
- (xv) The society portrayed in the short story "The Pedestrian" can be best described as \_\_\_\_\_.
- (a) A lively and close-knit community where people often interact outdoors.
  - (b) A future society where people live in isolation, controlled by technology and television.
  - (c) A quiet countryside where people live simple and peaceful lives.
  - (d) A city slowly recovering from the effects of war and destruction.
- (xvi) Choose the option that lists the sequence of events from Stephen Leacock's short story "With the Photographer" in the correct order:
1. The photographer came over and took the narrator's head and twisted it sideways.
  2. The photographer crawled back into the machine again and drew a little black cloth over himself.
  3. The photographer asked the narrator to droop his ears a little more.
  4. The narrator read the Ladies Companion for 1912.
- (a) 3, 2, 1, 4
  - (b) 4, 1, 3, 2
  - (c) 2, 1, 3, 4
  - (d) 4, 2, 1, 3

**SECTION B**  
**DRAMA**  
**(Julius Caesar by William Shakespeare)**

**Question 2**

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Cassius: ...look, the villains fly.  
Myself have to mine own turn'd enemy;  
This ensign here of mine was turning back;  
I slew the coward, and did take it from him.*

- (i) Where is this scene taking place? Who is Cassius speaking to? Explain the following line: “*Myself have to mine own turn'd enemy*”. [3]
- (ii) According to the listener, what wrong decision had Brutus taken in this context? Who is Pindarus? What news did Pindarus bring soon after? [3]
- (iii) According to you, what is Cassius’ state of mind at this moment? What did Cassius think had happened to the listener? How was this thought proven to be incorrect later in the play? [3]
- (iv) A little later in the scene, Cassius tells Pindarus, “... *And then I swore thee, saving of thy life/That whatsoever I did bid thee do, /Thou should'st attempt it.*” What does Cassius “bid thee do”? What does Brutus say in honour of Cassius at the end of the scene? [3]
- (v) In a later scene, what makes Brutus say, “*I know my hour is come.*”? Which are the two places where Brutus had seen Caesar’s ghost? If you meet Caesar’s ghost, what might it say to you about Brutus? [4]

**Question 3**

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Antony: Moreover, he hath left you all his walks,  
His private arbours, and new-planted orchards,  
On this side Tiber; he hath left them you,  
And to your heirs for ever.*

- (i) Who is being referred to as ‘he’? Where does this scene take place? What does the First Citizen say soon after? [3]
- (ii) A little later in the scene, a servant enters. What information does he bring? How does Antony react on listening to the information given? What further question does Antony ask the servant? [3]
- (iii) What does the servant tell Antony about Brutus and Cassius? We know that Brutus allowed Antony to speak at Caesar’s funeral despite opposition from Cassius. What impression do you form about Brutus’ and Cassius’ characters from this incident? [3]
- (iv) Brutus was the first person to address the Romans after the assassination of Caesar. Why do you think that he was chosen to address the crowd? What does Brutus say would have happened to the Romans if Caesar had been alive and ruling? According to Brutus, how would Mark Antony benefit from Caesar’s death? [3]
- (v) What were the conditions given to Mark Antony when he wanted to speak in Caesar’s funeral? Comment on the nature of the Roman mob after analysing their response to the speeches given by Brutus and Antony. [4]

**SECTION C**  
**PROSE – SHORT STORIES**  
(Treasure Chest- A Collection of Poems and Short Stories)

**Question 4**

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Then, as I hurried by as fast as I could go, the blacksmith, Wachter, who was there, with his apprentice, reading the bulletin, called after me: "Don't go so fast, bub; you'll get to your school in plenty of time!"*

- (i) Why was Franz in 'great dread' at the beginning of the story? What was 'much more tempting' for him? [3]
- (ii) Where had the crowd gathered? What bad news had arrived from there over the past two years? [3]
- (iii) State what different noises could be heard when the school began. Which political event serves at the background of the story? [3]
- (iv) Who were the villagers sitting in the classroom? Why had they come there? Why is the line 'Bah! I've plenty of time.' ironical in the present situation? [3]
- (v) What did M. Hamel write on the blackboard before dismissing school? What does that phrase mean? Imagine that you are Franz. What would your farewell message be for M. Hamel and why? [4]

**Question 5**

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Maybe that is why any time I don't finish eating my food, Nana says, 'You, Adjoa, you don't know what life is about...you don't know what problems there are in this life...'*

- (i) How old was Adjoa? Where was Adjoa born? What is the place known for? [3]
- (ii) What was apparently wrong with Adjoa's legs? According to Nana, what kind of legs should a woman have and why? [3]
- (iii) What was the distance between Adjoa's 'little village' and 'the small town'? Elucidate the contrasting opinion that Nana and Kaya had regarding school. [3]
- (iv) What was the reaction of Nana when she came to know that Adjoa was chosen by her teachers to run for the junior section of the school in the district games? How did Nana show extra care towards Adjoa when the news was confirmed? [3]
- (v) Which cup did Adjoa win? Why do you think it was important for her to win the race? Suggest an alternative title to this short story with suitable justification. [4]

**SECTION D**  
**POETRY**  
(Treasure Chest- A Collection of Poems and Short Stories)

**Question 6**

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*And when great souls die,  
after a period peace blooms,  
slowly and always  
irregularly.*

- (i) How does the world of nature react when great trees fall? [3]

- (ii) The poet says, “*Our memory, suddenly sharpened,*  
*examines,*  
*gnaws on kind words*  
*unsaid,*  
*promised walks*  
*never taken.*” [3]
- Mention which emotion is expressed through the above quoted lines. What happens to the senses when a great tree falls? Describe the air around us when great souls die.
- (iii) How do we see after great souls die? How do our souls change after the death of great souls? [3]
- (iv) According to the poet, why does peace always bloom ‘irregularly’? What happens to our senses after peace blooms? [3]
- Explain the following lines: “*They existed. They existed.*  
*We can be. Be and be*  
*better. For they existed.*”
- (v) Analyse how the mood of the poem changes in the end. Why do you think this poem will provide some emotional support to those who have lost their loved ones? Suggest an alternative title to this poem with suitable justification. [4]

### Question 7

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*This was no dust speck by my breathing blown,  
 But unmistakably a living mite  
 With inclinations it could call its own.*

- (i) What was the speaker doing when he noticed the speck? What did he think it to be at first? What did it turn out to be on closer inspection? [3]
- (ii) What does the speaker mean by “*With inclinations it could call its own*”? How did the ‘speck’ react when it came across the part of the manuscript which was not yet dry? [3]
- (iii) Why did the ‘speck’ cower down in the middle of the open sheet? What did the poet finally decide to do with it? Why? [3]
- (iv) Explain the lines: “*Collectivistic regimenting love*  
*With which the modern world is being swept.*” [3]
- Why do you think the poet was glad to find ‘it’ on the sheet? Mention something small or insignificant in your surrounding that holds importance and brings you joy.
- (v) Which character trait of the speaker appeals to you and why? List any one theme of the poem with proper textual justification. [4]